Session 2: Laying the Groundwork — Goal Setting & Market Selection



Session Duration: 30 minutes

Primary Outcome: Each agent will walk away with an understanding of how to define an income goal, deal target, listing appointment requirement, and an initial geographic/property focus to help guide their prospecting strategy.

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Session Objectives

By the end of this session, agents will understand how to:

Set A Goal: How to Set a Realistic 12-Month GCI Target

Determine The Level of Activity Necessary to Achieve Your Target

Identify a high-opportunity geographic farm and property type to pursue

Understand how to organize this information so you can create a focused, specialized Go-To-Market plan — rooted in data, not guesswork!!!



Segment 1: Why Goals Without Strategy Fail

> **"We're not here to stay busy. We're here to build businesses."**
>
> Without clear strategy, efforts lead to stagnation; a well-defined plan ensures sustainable growth.



The Reactive Agent Trap

Many agents operate reactively, leading to inconsistent results, income fluctuations, and a feeling of being busy without measurable progress.



The Proactive Producer's Edge

Top producers use clear numbers, defined strategies, and systematized focus for consistent, predictable growth. Their success comes from deliberate planning and execution.



The High Cost of Guesswork

Operating without a defined strategy wastes time and resources. It leads to burnout, missed opportunities, and unpredictable income, hindering long-term stability.



Strategy: Your Roadmap to Predictability

A well-defined strategy serves as your roadmap, connecting aspirations to actionable steps. It translates income goals into daily activities, ensuring every effort aligns with desired outcomes for a predictable business.



Shift to Math-Based Action

This session is about shifting from emotion-based guesswork to concrete, math-based action. Leverage data to inform decisions, set quantifiable goals, and identify precise activities to build a sustainable real estate business.



"Start with your income goal, not random marketing tactics." — Top Producers' Cheat Sheet

This principle ensures purposeful actions that maximize efficiency and contribute directly to financial outcomes.

Segment 2: Define the Numbers That Define Your Business

Understanding your business means being clear on your numbers. By working backward from your income goal, you can create a precise, actionable plan for success.

Guided Exercise: "Work Backward From Your Income Goal"



Set Your Yearly Income Goal

Question: "What income amount gets you excited and feels achievable?" (e.g., $150K, $300K, $500K)

This realistic yet motivating target should align with your market and lifestyle. Break it into quarterly and monthly goals for easier tracking.



Divide by Your Average Commission Per Sale

Question: "How much do you typically earn from each completed sale?"

Example: $300K Income Goal ÷ $25K average = **12 sales needed per year**

Accuracy is key; use past sales data to determine your average commission. This converts your income goal directly into the number of sales needed.



Figure Out How Many Listing Appointments You Need

Question: "How many listing appointments turn into signed contracts?"

Example: 12 sales needed ÷ 30% success rate = 40 appointments per year, or about 1 per week

Your conversion rate is crucial. This step defines how many key appointments are needed to secure a sale, focusing efforts on income-generating activities.



Calculate Daily/Weekly Outreach Activity

Question: "How many outreach efforts (calls, emails, visits) lead to a qualified appointment?"

Example: 40 appointments needed ÷ 10% conversion = 400 qualified leads per year

This final step translates goals into daily tasks. Knowing required outreach efforts ensures direct alignment with your income goal, providing a clear daily action plan.

> ***"Success is about important appointments, not just hours worked."***

This "working backward" exercise transforms a large income goal into measurable, achievable daily tasks, forming the basis of a smart business plan.

Segment 3: Market Selection — Where You Hunt Matters

Duration: 10 minutes

> **"If your market doesn't have turnover... your plan is dead on arrival."**

🧭 Geographic Focus

Choosing the right territory is foundational. It's not just about what you know, but where opportunities consistently arise.

- Select a zip code or 2–3 neighborhoods with a proven track record of **5–7% annual turnover**. This ensures a consistent flow of potential transactions.
- Actively seek out underserved areas or locations experiencing significant growth in demand, as these present unique entry points.
- Leverage tools like Navigate to meticulously verify turnover rates, property counts, and demographic shifts within your chosen areas.
- Beyond turnover, consider factors like average price point, community development, and local amenities that attract your ideal client.

Prompt: "What 1–2 neighborhoods do you know *well enough* to dominate, and how will you deepen your expertise there?"

🏠 Property Type Focus

Specialization can significantly refine your marketing efforts and establish you as the go-to expert.

- Identify specific home types you feel genuinely confident discussing and transacting. This could range from luxury condos to distressed properties.
- Focus on areas where you have demonstrated success or possess extensive familiarity, whether it's navigating the complexities of multi-family units, understanding ADU regulations, or specializing in flip properties.
- Consider the unique buyer and seller motivations associated with each property type, allowing you to tailor your approach effectively.
- Specializing allows for more efficient lead generation and the development of a targeted value proposition.

Prompt: "If someone gave you 10 listings tomorrow, what kind would you want, and what makes you the best agent for that specific property type?"

Segment 4: Owner Selection — Who You Target Matters

👤 Ideal Owner Profile

To truly understand your market, move beyond basic demographics. Focus on the *situations* and motivations that drive property owners to sell.

Long-time ownership

These owners often have significant equity and may be considering a move to a home that better fits their plans.

Right-Sizing

When a home no longer fits how the owner uses it, the upkeep can become a burden and a strong motivation to sell.

Inherited property

Heirs may be motivated by the need to liquidate assets quickly or may not want the responsibility of managing a new property.

Investors losing rental yield

Changes in market conditions, tenant issues, or rising costs can prompt investors to divest.

Job relocation

A sudden job change often necessitates a quick sale, regardless of market timing.

Change in plans

A new opportunity, a change in finances or a shift in plans can create urgent needs to buy or sell.

Property in disrepair

Owners who cannot or will not invest in necessary repairs may be open to selling "as-is."

Understanding these scenarios allows you to craft messages that resonate deeply, addressing their specific pain points and offering solutions, rather than just generic marketing.

Segment 5: Putting This All Together — Creating Your "GTM" Plan

Having laid the groundwork for a robust real estate business, it's time to consolidate the critical elements you've defined. This segment is dedicated to integrating your financial aspirations with your market strategy, creating a clear, actionable Go-To-Market (GTM) plan that's rooted in data and strategic insights.

Building Blocks...

1

🎯 Income Goal

You've set a specific Gross Commission Income (GCI) target for the next 12 months. This isn't just a wish; it's the financial cornerstone guiding all your subsequent actions and strategic decisions.

2

🧮 Deal Target

Based on your GCI goal and average commission per transaction, you've reverse-engineered the precise number of deals you need to close. This transforms a big financial number into a manageable, measurable sales objective.

3

📅 Activity Requirement

From your deal target, you've identified the concrete activities required, specifically the number of listing appointments you need to generate. This metric provides a clear, weekly benchmark for your proactive outreach and engagement efforts.

1

📍 Geographic Focus

You've pinpointed the high-opportunity zip codes or neighborhoods with proven turnover rates that will serve as your primary hunting grounds. This strategic choice maximizes your potential for consistent transaction flow.

2

🏠 Property Type

You've refined your specialization to specific property types where you possess expertise or see untapped potential. This focus allows you to become the go-to authority in a niche, attracting ideal clients more efficiently.

3

👤 Seller Profile

Beyond demographics, you've delved into the specific situations and motivations that drive property owners to sell. Understanding these profiles enables you to craft highly relevant messages and solutions, resonating deeply with potential sellers.

This integrated GTM plan — from your income aspirations down to the specific property owner profiles you'll target — forms a powerful roadmap. It moves you away from reactive busywork towards a focused, predictable, and scalable business model designed for consistent growth. By locking in these elements, you're building a foundation that will truly define your success in the market.

Preview Session 3: "Next time, we bring this plan to life using Navigate — where property meets probability. You'll see just how much faster, smarter, and more targeted your prospecting becomes when data does the heavy lifting."

Post-Session Homework: Foundation Planning Worksheet

Send this as a fillable Google Doc or PDF.

Section	Agent Response
12-Month Income Goal (GCI)	
Avg. Commission per Deal	
Deals Needed to Hit Goal	
Listing Appts Needed	
Target Area(s) (Zip/Neighborhood)	
Property Type Specialization	
Ideal Seller Profile	

Final Thoughts...



> ***"Prospecting gets easier when you're not chasing everything. You're building a system — and it starts with knowing who you're for, where you play, and what you're working toward."***

Key Takeaway: This session has been all about empowering you to move beyond random acts of marketing and instead, implement a predictable and powerful system for growth. By clearly defining your ideal client, understanding your prime hunting grounds, and setting concrete, measurable goals, you're transforming your business into a strategic operation rather than a series of disconnected efforts.

Food For Thought: Remember, true efficiency and scalability come from clarity. When you know precisely "who you're for" — your ideal seller profile — your messaging becomes sharp and compelling. When you understand "where you play" — your target geographic areas and property types — your prospecting efforts are no longer scattered but laser-focused. And when you commit to "what you're working toward" — your income and deal targets — every action you take is purposeful and aligned with your ultimate success.

My Ask of You: Embrace this newfound clarity. It's the foundation upon which a truly thriving and sustainable real estate business is built.